

TOEFL REVIEW

PRACTICE QUESTIONS



LESSON GOAL

In this review, you will:

- apply reading strategies from all three units
- recognize different question types
- locate evidence and compare it with the answer choices
- use several reading skills within one passage



KEY IDEA

USE THE RIGHT STRATEGY

A mixed review does not tell you which lesson to use.

First, identify what the question is asking. Then choose the matching strategy.

IDENTIFY → APPLY → CHECK



STRATEGY REFERENCE

Details → Find the evidence.

Meaning → Check the context.

Connections → Look around the sentence.

Inference → Use clues, not guesses.



Reading Practice 01

Building Hoover Dam

The Colorado River flows through a large, dry region of the American West. For many years, the river was both helpful and dangerous. Farmers depended on its water to grow crops, but sudden floods could destroy fields and homes. At other times, there was not enough water for nearby communities. Government leaders began discussing the construction of a large dam that could control the river, store water, and produce electricity.

In 1928, the United States government approved the Boulder Canyon Project. The plan included building a dam in Black Canyon, near the border between Arizona and Nevada. Herbert Hoover, who later became president, had helped states in the region reach an agreement about sharing the Colorado River's water. The structure eventually became known as Hoover Dam, although it was also called Boulder Dam for several years.

Construction began in 1931, during the Great Depression. At a time when many Americans were unemployed, thousands of people traveled west hoping to find work on the project. However, the jobs were extremely **demanding**. Summer temperatures in the construction tunnels sometimes reached about 60°C. Workers also faced falling rocks, dangerous equipment, and poor air quality. Although the project offered employment, it was far from safe or comfortable.

Before workers could build the dam across the river, they had to move the river out of the way. Crews cut four enormous tunnels through the walls of Black Canyon. Water was directed through these tunnels, leaving part of the original riverbed dry. Workers could then begin constructing the dam. Rather than pouring all the concrete into one giant form, engineers built the dam from many separate blocks. **This method** allowed the concrete to cool more quickly and reduced the chance of cracking.

Hoover Dam was completed in the 1930s and became one of the most impressive engineering achievements of its time. It helped control flooding, supplied water to growing communities, and generated electricity. The reservoir created behind it, Lake Mead, also stored a huge amount of water. However, the dam changed the natural movement of the Colorado River and affected ecosystems downstream. Hoover Dam therefore brought important benefits while also producing long-term environmental changes.

1. The word **demanding** in **paragraph 3** is closest in meaning to:
 - A) popular
 - B) difficult
 - C) temporary
 - D) unfamiliar

2. According to **paragraph 2**, what role did Herbert Hoover play before the dam was built?
 - A) He designed the tunnels through Black Canyon.
 - B) He helped regional states agree about the river's water.
 - C) He selected the workers who constructed the dam.
 - D) He ordered the dam to be renamed Boulder Dam.

3. All of the following are mentioned in **paragraph 3** as difficulties faced by workers EXCEPT:
 - A) extremely high temperatures
 - B) dangerous machinery
 - C) poor air quality
 - D) regular flooding inside the tunnels

4. **This method** in **paragraph 4** refers to:
 - A) directing water through tunnels
 - B) leaving part of the riverbed dry
 - C) building the dam from separate concrete blocks
 - D) cutting tunnels through the canyon walls

5. What can be inferred about the decision to build Hoover Dam during the Great Depression?
 - A) The project attracted workers partly because other jobs were difficult to find.
 - B) Most workers had previous experience building large dams.
 - C) The government created the project mainly to reduce unemployment.
 - D) Workers were paid more because the project was located in a desert.

6. Why does the author mention Lake Mead in **paragraph 5**?
 - A) To provide an example of a reservoir created by the dam
 - B) To compare two rivers in the American West
 - C) To explain where most workers lived during construction
 - D) To describe the natural environment before the dam was built